

HOUSE No. 617

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Hannah Kane

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act establishing an educational mandate task force.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Hannah Kane</i>	<i>11th Worcester</i>	<i>1/7/2025</i>
<i>Colleen M. Garry</i>	<i>36th Middlesex</i>	<i>1/25/2025</i>
<i>Bradley H. Jones, Jr.</i>	<i>20th Middlesex</i>	<i>1/29/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 617

By Representative Kane of Shrewsbury, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 617) of Hannah Kane, Colleen M. Garry and Bradley H. Jones, Jr., for an investigation by a special task force (including members of the General Court) relative to review existing state mandates placed on public schools and districts in the Commonwealth. Education.

[SIMILAR MATTER FILED IN PREVIOUS SESSION
SEE HOUSE, NO. 511 OF 2023-2024.]

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act establishing an educational mandate task force.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 There shall be an educational mandate task force to review existing state mandates placed
2 on public schools and districts in the Commonwealth. The task force shall consist of 11
3 members: the house and senate chairs of the joint committee on education, or their designees,
4 who shall serve as the co-chairs of the task force; a member of the general court appointed by the
5 senate minority leader; a member of the general court appointed by the house minority leader;
6 the commissioner of elementary and secondary education, or a designee; and 6 persons to be
7 appointed by the secretary of education, 1 of whom shall be selected from a list of 3 persons
8 nominated by the Massachusetts Association of School Superintendents, 1 of whom shall be
9 selected from a list of 3 persons nominated by the Massachusetts Association of School
10 Committees, 1 of whom shall be selected from a list of 3 persons nominated by the

Massachusetts Association of School Business Officials, 1 of whom shall be selected from a list of 3 persons nominated by the Massachusetts Secondary School Administrators' Association, 1 of whom shall be selected from a list of 3 persons nominated by the Massachusetts Elementary School Principals' Association, and 1 of whom shall be selected from a list of 3 persons nominated by the Massachusetts Administrators of Special Education.

The task force shall: (i) identify and review the state laws, regulations, and administrative directives that prescribe requirements for school districts, including those that require school districts to prepare and submit reports and data to the department of elementary and secondary education; (ii) identify the state laws that require the department of elementary and secondary education to submit reports to the legislature based on information it must obtain from school districts; and (iii) develop recommendations to streamline, consolidate, or eliminate such mandates or reporting requirements that are outdated, or duplicative of or inconsistent with current laws, regulations or practices. In developing its recommendations, the task force shall consider the feasibility of creating a single master reporting form to prevent duplicate information from being reported by school districts more than once yearly. Such recommendations shall also include a process for ensuring that new state laws or regulations do not duplicate existing reporting requirements.

The first meeting of the task force shall take place within 60 days of the effective date of this act. The task force shall file a report containing its findings and recommendations, including legislative recommendations, if any, with the clerks of the house and senate not later than 12 months following the first meeting of the task force. Prior to issuing its recommendations, the task force shall conduct at least one public hearing to receive testimony from members of the public.